



If you are someone who is good at discovering and communicating meaningful patterns in data and are looking for a career in data analytics, target IT software companies, and be prepared to relocate to the south—Vivek Madhukar, COO, TimesJobs.com

Notable Organisations Hiring in this Domain

1. Tata Communications
2. Ericsson
3. Amazon
4. GE
5. IBM
6. Honeywell
7. Shell
8. NTT Data

Typical Entry-Level Job Profiles in Analytics

1. Business analyst
2. Data analyst/data scientist analyst
3. Data manager
4. Data engineer

make a career in data analytics is huge,” says Kaushank Nalin Khandwala, manager, Data Centre and Analytics Lab, IIM Bangalore.

Current opportunities for engineers

In the coming decade, social, mobile, analytics and cloud (SMAC) are the strategic focus areas for many technology companies. The entry-level roles in analytics are in the areas of data modelling, data visualisation, business analysis and reporting.

Apart from their core field, engineers are now hired by IT companies, KPOs, captive analytics units and niche analytics organisations across various entry-level roles, such as management trainees, analysts and assistant managers in the risk, marketing and analytics consulting roles. Over the last 14 months, the spike in big data roles has also added to the mix.

There are a lot of opportunities for fresh engineering graduates who have the right kind of skill set. The entry-level roles generally involve a profile where the graduates are required to aggregate, compile and screen the data and also prepare a datasheet for further analysis. In addition, they may also be asked to explore the data to find some insights before applying any data analysis technique.

For engineers, roles will also be of programmers, specifically for Java, Python and R.

Freshers with good knowledge of Hadoop and cloud computing will have a distinct advantage.

For experienced graduates, roles range from business intelligence specialists, programmers, open source experts to Hadoop engineers, cloud computing experts, Java, Python, text mining specialists and domain specialists.

Pay package

At PayScale.com, the average salary indicated for an entry-level data analyst is ₹ 257,383 per year. The skills that increase pay for this job the most are SAS, SPSS and quality improvement/QA.

A mid-career data analyst earns an average salary of ₹ 400,236 per year. The highest paying skills associated with this job are database, SAS, Microsoft SQL server and SQL (refer charts).

Some industry experts preferred to keep the pay packages confidential and the others gave us a basic idea. At Costarch, Soni informs, “We do recruit engineers to work in this domain with our company but we do not have any fixed pay package for our recruits and it depends very much on their skill sets. But to give you an idea, the entry-level package varies between ₹ 240,000 and ₹ 450,000 and for experienced professionals, it varies between ₹ 500,000 to ₹ 1,000,000.”

Demand areas

Vivek Madhukar, COO, TimesJobs.com explained, “DA is a high-demand profession that is going to continue to attract the best and brightest technological minds for a long time to come—many CIOs today started out as DA specialists. DA is the job of finding business insights in figures and facts—at a junior-to-mid-level career this comprises extracting information from raw data. At a mid-to-senior-level position, this information is processed into knowledge that is leveraged for business growth.”

He further adds, “If you are someone who is good at discovering and communicating meaningful patterns in data and are looking for a career in DA, target IT software companies and be prepared to relocate to the south—as Bangalore, Chennai and Hyderabad account for almost half of the jobs available in this sector.”

According to the data provided by TimesJobs.com, the top industries hiring DA professionals is the IT industry with about 42 per cent share of jobs followed by the manufacturing and engineering industry with a share of 10 per cent. Banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) and ITES-BPO (information technology-enabled service-business process outsourcing) have 9 per cent and 4 per cent of the jobs, respectively (refer pie charts).

Apart from Bangalore and Mumbai that feature in the list of top locations for jobs in the DA field with 25 per cent and 16 per cent, respectively, Delhi shares 19 per cent of the jobs and, Chennai and Hyderabad with 10 per cent of the jobs each. Remaining jobs are scattered in other locations (refer pie charts).

Skills expected

Both freshers and experienced graduates should have a balanced mix of left brain and right brain skills, informs Anand. They need to be able to both count and connect the dots, be curious enough to question everything they see and sceptical enough not to ac-